

global mining sector while contributing to the nation's strategic goals of resource security and economic growth.

Sustainability is a very crucial global pledge taken to collectively save the planet Earth through several initiatives to contain carbon emissions and green the environment. Since mining involves delving into the depths of the Earth, how are you giving back to the environment and the communities affected by the mining activities in their neighborhood?

At NMDC, we recognize the immense responsibility that comes with mining, and sustainability is a core part of our identity. We're committed not just to minimizing our environmental footprint but also to making a positive impact on the communities we operate in.

In an effort to reduce our environmental impact, we have successfully reduced our Greenhouse Gas (GHG) emissions by 24% over the last nine years. In FY 2023-24, NMDC increased its renewable energy usage by 40%, consuming 1.8 million units of solar energy. Additionally, our 10.5 MW wind project has been registered with the United Nations Framework Convention for Climate Change (UNFCCC), showcasing our dedication to powering a greener future.

Our extensive land reclamation projects focus on restoring mined areas through reforestation, soil conservation, and ecosystem rehabilitation. To date, NMDC has planted more than 3 million trees around our mining sites, ensuring that our activities contribute to the regeneration of the natural environment. We also implement

rainwater harvesting projects to further enhance environmental conservation.

Water conservation is another major priority for us. We've put in place measures to minimize water usage and reduce our impact on local water resources, understanding how crucial water sustainability is in mining operations. Ensuring environmental sustainability in all aspects of ore mining, crushing, and screening operations remains a key focus area for NMDC.

Alongside our environmental initiatives, we're also committed to uplifting the communities around our mining sites. Through our Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) programs, we've launched several key initiatives, such as the Shiksha Sahayog Yojana and Balika Shiksha Yojana, which provide educational benefits for tribal children, helping them achieve their dreams and fostering economic empowerment.

Looking ahead, we are dedicated to setting new norms for responsible mining, ensuring that our operations not only protect but also enhance the environment and the well-being of the communities we serve.

As India heads towards celebrating its centenary of independence in 2047, how would you interpret NMDC's vision of "India@100"?

At NMDC, we are fully aligned with India's ambitious goal of becoming a \$35 trillion economy by 2047, and we have a bold roadmap to support this vision. As India aims to triple its steel production capacity to 500 million tonnes per year by 2047, with an interim target of 300 million tonnes by 2030, NMDC is committed to playing a crucial role in this national

endeavour. In line with these requirements, we are on track to expand our production capacity to 100 million tonnes by FY30, ensuring that we meet the growing demand for iron ore, both for domestic steel production and international markets.

Our vision for "India@100" also includes reducing the nation's dependency on imported resources. Recognizing India's status as a net importer of coking coal, NMDC has acquired an 8 MTPA coking coal block, with operations expected to commence by December 2025. Additionally, NMDC, through its subsidiary LIOL, is set to embark on lithium mining operations in Australia. This strategic move will secure a stable supply of lithium, reducing India's import dependency and conserving valuable foreign exchange reserves.

NMDC is also conducting advanced exploration activities for iron ore, bauxite, manganese, diamonds, and gold, with plans to acquire additional areas. These new operations are anticipated to come online beyond FY2030, further enhancing our contribution to India's resource security.

As India aims to emerge as a developed nation, NMDC is committed to driving industrial development, economic progress, job creation, and regional growth. We are fostering technological advancements, enhancing our R&D capabilities, and building a skilled workforce ready to meet the challenges of the future. Through strategic investments in renewable energy, digital transformation, and sustainable mining practices, NMDC will continue to play a key role in India's inclusive and sustainable growth vision, ensuring that the benefits of our progress reach every corner of the nation.

